

IUCN Category Card-Sorting Game

Conservation Biology

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Why We're Playing

This game helps you learn the six IUCN protected-area categories (Ia–VI) by matching:

- **Definitions** (what each category means)
- **Real-world examples** (actual parks or reserves)
- **Management objectives** (how each area is run)

By the end, you'll be able to:

- Recognize each category's purpose
 - Link a definition to a famous site
 - Understand the management goals behind each protected area
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What You'll Do

1. Get a Card

- You'll receive **one card**: a definition, an example site, or an objective.

2. Mingle

- Stand up and talk to classmates—describe only what's on your card (no category numbers!).
- Find the **two people** whose cards match yours (one definition + one example + one objective).

3. Race to the Board

- Once you form a trio, run to the board and post all three cards under the header that fits your category.

4. Score Points

- The first trio to place all three cards correctly wins **1 point** for that category.
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Rules

- **No naming numbers:** Describe only the text on your card or the text on the card you are looking for.
 - **No swapping cards** once you've committed to a group.
 - **Challenge:** If you think a trio is under the wrong header, call over the instructor for a quick check.
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Winning & Reflection

- **Winning:** Fastest correct group per category earns the point. We'll play multiple rounds—try different roles!
- **Quick Debrief:** After each round, one trio per category will share in 30 seconds:
 1. How you recognized your category
 2. Any surprises or tricky distinctions

Cat	Name	Primary Objective	Typical Examples/Activities
Ia	Strict Nature Reserve	Preserve biodiversity & geological/geomorphological features; human use limited to research & monitoring.	Scientific research; undisturbed baseline monitoring
Ib	Wilderness Area	Protect large-scale natural areas where ecosystems can evolve freely; minimal human infrastructure.	Remote trekking; low-impact wilderness experience
II	National Park	Safeguard functioning ecosystems; allow education, recreation & visitor facilities compatible with conservation.	Hiking, wildlife viewing, environmental education programs
III	Natural Monument or Feature	Protect a specific natural monument (e.g. landform, sea mount, cave) and its immediate surroundings.	Guided tours; interpretation of unique geological/cultural sites
IV	Habitat/Species Management	Active interventions (e.g. habitat restoration, species reintroduction) to maintain or recover particular species/habitats.	Controlled burns; invasive species removal; nest protection
V	Protected Land-scape/Seascape	Conserve areas shaped by human–nature interactions, preserving cultural values and scenic character.	Traditional agriculture; cultural tourism; sustainable forestry
VI	Sustainable Resource Use	Combine conservation with sustainable, low-level natural resource use by local communities.	Community forestry; small-scale grazing; traditional fisheries